



Fiddling with the Bash prompt

Given below are some tips about the bash prompt, which is only the first of a couple of prompts you might see.

The value for the bash prompt is stored in an environment variable called *PS1*. To see its value, type the following command:

```
$echo $PS1
```

This will give you an output something like what's shown below:

```
[\[e]0;\u@h: \w\[\[033[01;32m\]\u@h\[\[033[00m\]:\[\[033[01;34m\]\w\[\[033[00m\]\$
```

To change it, you can set a new value for the variable:

```
export PS1="\u > "
```

This will result in a prompt like the one given below:

```
testuser >
```

To make the changes permanent, you can append them to the end of *.bash_profile* or *.bashrc* file in your home directory.

Given below is an almost complete list of options that can be changed in the bash prompt:

\a	The 'bell' character
\A	24h Time
\d	Date (e.g. Tue Dec 21)
\e	The 'escape' character
\h	Hostname (up to the first ".")
\H	Hostname
\j	No. of jobs currently running (ps)
\l	Current tty
\n	Line feed
\t	Time (hh:mm:ss)
\T	Time (hh:mm:ss, 12h format)
\r	Carriage return
\s	Shell (i.e. bash, zsh, ksh..)
\u	Username
\v	Bash version
\V	Full Bash release string
\w	Current working directory
\W	Last part of the current working directory
\!	Current index in history
\#	Command index
\\$	A "#" if you're root, else "\$"

\\	Literal Backslash
\@	Time (12h format with am/pm)

—Sonam, info@nixtrainer.com

Sorting directories

Here is a small tip to sort directories of the current directory by size (up to one level):

```
du -m --max-depth 1 | sort -rn
```

Output:

```
456 ./arduino-1.8.5
1 ./libraries
```

In the above code 456 and 1 are in megabytes.

Now let's see what is the output for folder size when the max-depth is 2.

```
du -m --max-depth 2 | sort -rn
```

```
456 ./arduino-1.8.5
198 ./arduino-1.8.5/java
179 ./arduino-1.8.5/hardware
31 ./arduino-1.8.5/reference
21 ./arduino-1.8.5/libraries
19 ./arduino-1.8.5/lib
6 ./arduino-1.8.5/examples
2 ./arduino-1.8.5/tools
1 ./libraries
1 ./arduino-1.8.5/tools-builder
```

—Anupam Mukherjee, cesiumanugit@gmail.com



Swapping between terminals

We can use *Ctrl+Shift+T* shortcut keys to open a terminal. You can be on the same terminal, and again use the same combination to open another window for you. You can shift between terminals using the key combination *Shift+Ctrl* and *PageUp/PageDown*.

—Gurminder Singh Parmar,
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